archive.today
webpage capture
Saved from https://medium.com/commitlog/in-memory-of-dennis-ritchie search
21 May 2022 14:11:37 UTC
no other snapshots from this url
All snapshots from host medium.com
Webpage Screenshot
share download .zip report bug or abuse Buy me a coffee

Sign In Get started

Published in Commit Log

You have **2** free member-only stories left this month.
Sign up for Medium and get an extra one

Follow
Oct 10, 2017 · 2 min read ★ · Listen

In Memory of Dennis Ritchie

Remembering The Creator of Steve Jobs, Linus Torvalds and Bill Gates

A few days after Steve Jobs passed; on October 12th in 2011 Dennis Ritchie passed away at the age of 70.

At the time everyone was talking about how Jobs changed computing, while there is no doubt that the Apple cult has been a success they could never have done it without Ritchie and co.

We’ve had two Jobs movies, I say it’s time for a Bell Labs movie!

Why? Well, Dennis and friends were extremely productive while working over at Bell Labs, amongst other things he co-created Unix with Ken Thompson, he wrote the book on the C programming language along with Brian Kerningan and he also wrote the language itself.

The World Runs on Unix

It's safe to say that Unix turned out to be a great successes, Unix became the golden standard for operating system, OS X, Linux, Android, Chrome OS, PlayStation and even the Nintendo Switch are Unix-like systems.

Kerninghan, Thompson and Ritchie talking about how UNIX works at Bell Labs

The World Is Written in C

C ended up being just as prevalent, with not only a vast majority of operating systems being C based, most of the world's code being either written in C, or in the case of user-space programs, running on a runtime that is written in C or C derived language like C++.

Your browser? That's most likely written in C too, unless you're on that **one** browser written in Rust.

Kerninghan talking about C and it's influences

On a more personal note, C is the way I got into programming way back in 1990s armed with a copy of The C Programming Language and although I don't get to use it that often anymore, there's still something to be said about the purity of the language.

It doesn't get in the way, it has just enough to be a high level language with access to low level details, this is my personal bias but *I think it's a beautiful language*.

In closing, I'll leave you with Dennis Ritchie's webpage as memorialized by Bell Labs which contains some interesting tidbits like like the user manuals to BCPL and B.

Get an email whenever Casper Beyer publishes.

Your email

Subscribe

By signing up, you will create a Medium account if you don't already have one. Review our Privacy Policy for more information about our privacy practices.

More from Commit Log

Follow

Contains Commits, Duh!

Casper Beyer · Aug 4, 2017 ★

Why I Still Use Vim

And no, it's not because I can't figure out how to close it. — I often get asked about why I use Vim as my primary editor, there is no particular reason for this, except that I ended up learning it when I moved over to…

Vim 3 min read

Read more from Commit Log

Recommended from Medium

means of setting this config.

How Leaders are Improving Agility with User Stories

Do You Have a Mac? Try Changing The Folder Icon

InsureDao: Insurance in DeFi

in NestedIf

How to write responsive HTML for emailer

CI/CD using AWS Code Deploy

IOC Container in nodejs

Comparing CLI Building Libraries

Medium

About Help Terms Privacy